

Japanese art

From the 14th to the late 16th century, Japan was ruled by shoguns from the Ashikaga family. Great patrons of art, they commissioned the building of many Zen temples, and under their rule, several art forms originated, including Noh (a form of musical drama), ink painting, garden design, flower arranging and the tea ceremony. Great artists of the period included Sesshū Tōyō (1420–1506), a master of ink and wash painting. Influenced by Chinese Song Dynasty landscape painting, he had a large following now known as the 'School of Sesshū'. Kanō Eitoku (1543–90) created expressive, large-scale landscapes, and Hasegawa Tōhaku (1539–1610) began painting Buddhist images, but after the 1580s, produced atmospheric paintings.

Most painting was executed in rapid brushstrokes with few details. By the late 14th century, monochrome landscapes (*sansui ga*) were fashionable. The Kanō School established by Kanō Masanobu (1434–1530) lasted to the 19th century, adopting Chinese painting style, with strong emphasis on brushwork, ink and natural subjects.



Hasegawa Tōhaku, *Pine Trees* (section), 1593